

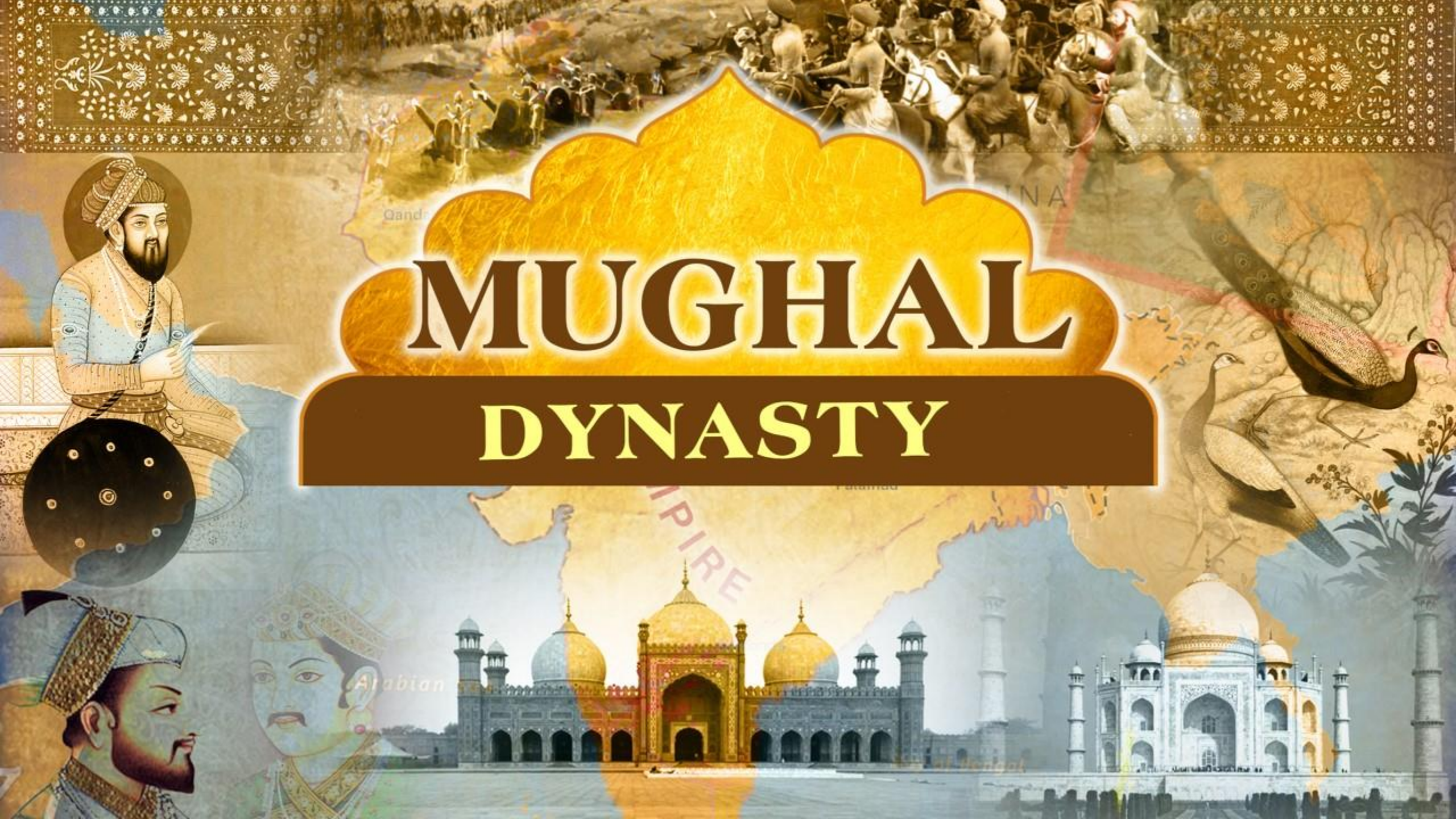
MEDIEVAL HISTORY



MODULE - 23

MUGHAL DYNASTY
AKBAR – PART 1





MUGHAL DYNASTY



Arabian



EMPIRE

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

INTRODUCTION



- 1 One of the greatest monarchs of the Mughal dynasty
- 2 He was the son of Humayun and Hamida Banu Begam, and was born at Amarkot in 1542 AD.
- 3 When Humayun fled to Iran, young Akbar was captured by his uncle Kamran, but he treated him well.
- 4 When Humayun died, Akbar was crowned in 1556 AD, at the age of 13 years by Bairam Khan.
- 5 Bairam Khan was a military commander who ran administration under the name of Akbar as Akbar was still young.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

REGENCY PERIOD OF BAIRAM KHAN (1556-60 AD)



- 1 Bairam Khan was Humayun's trusted officer and confidante, who served as Akbar's tutor as well as regent (wazir) of the kingdom with the title of Khan-i-Khanan.

- 2 Bairam Khan represented Akbar in the Second battle of Panipat (1556 AD) with Hemu (Wazir of Mohd. Shah Adil of Bengal) who led the Afghan forces who were posing a serious threat to the Mughal Empire.
- 3 Under guidance of Bairam Khan, the Mughals won a series of battles in quick succession and warded off other Afghan contenders like Sikander Sur.
- 4 Under Bairam Khan Mughals:
 - ✓ captured Lahore, Multan, Ajmer,
 - ✓ vanquished Ibrahim Sur
 - ✓ annexed Jaunpur.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

REGENCY PERIOD OF BAIRAM KHAN (1556-60 AD)



- 5 During this phase, Bairam Khan emerged as the most powerful noble and started appointing his own supporters on important positions neglecting the old nobles.
- 6 This caused resentment among other nobles who managed to influence Akbar as well. The problem was further aggravated by the growing arrogance of Bairam Khan.
- 7 Akbar now wanted to assume full control. He thus removed Bairam Khan, who revolted but was forced to submit.
- 8 Akbar still treated him cordially, and gave him the option of serving at the court or anywhere outside it, or retiring to Mecca. He decided to go to Mecca but was assassinated near Ahmedabad by an Afghan who bore him a personal grudge.
- 9 Akbar married his widow and took his infant son under his protection. His son later on became famous as the noted Hindi poet Abdur Rahim Khan-i Khana, an influential noble under Akbar.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

IMMEDIATE CHALLENGES OF AKBAR WITH RESPECT TO NOBILITY

He had two main challenges when he took over:

1. Political conspiracies and power struggle among nobles
2. Serious challenge from his Uzbek (central Asian) nobles who had broken out from Akbar

POWER STRUGGLE AMONG NOBLES

- 1 ■ During Bairam Khan's rebellion, groups in the nobility had become politically active.
 - This included Akbar's foster mother, Maham Anaga, her son, Adham Khan.
- 2 In 1561 AD, Adham Khan was victorious at Malwa by defeating Baz Bahadur.
- 3 Adham Khan followed his victory at Malwa with almost total massacre of the defending army, women, and children, and sent only parts of the booty to Akbar.
- 4 Removed from the command, he laid claim to the post of wazir, and when this was not conceded, he stabbed the acting wazir in his office.
- 5 Furious at his impropriety, Akbar had him thrown down from the Agra fort.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

CHALLENGE FROM HIS UZBEK NOBLES



1 Between 1561 AD and 1567 AD, Akbar was engulfed by serious challenge from his Uzbek (central Asian) nobles who broke out in rebellion several times. Many of them had come to India with Humayun.

- 2** Uzbeks declared Mirza Hakim, governor of Kabul as the emperor of Hindustan.
- 3** Another group of nobles, called Mirzas, also turned against the emperor.
- 4**
 - This was perhaps the most serious crisis Akbar had to face since him becoming the King.
 - However, by sheer grit and determination along with a certain amount of luck, Akbar was able to overcome these multiple threats.
- 5** Mirza Hakim was forced to withdraw to Kabul and the Mirzas were duly suppressed, while the Uzbeks were completely routed by 1567 AD.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

1 CONQUEST OF MALWA



1 Akbar started his policy of expansion with central India. In 1559–60 AD, the first expedition was sent to capture Gwalior before moving towards Malwa.

2 Mughals had defeated the Malwa ruler Baz Bahadur (under Adham Khan)

3 However, due to senseless cruelties of Adham Khan and his successor, there was a reaction against the Mughals which enabled Baz Bahadur to recover Malwa.

4 Akbar sent another expedition to Malwa. Baz Bahadur had to flee, and for some time he took shelter with the Rana of Mewar.

5 Eventually he surrendered at Akbar's court and was enrolled as a Mughal mansabdar. Thus, Malwa came under Mughal authority.



KASHMIR

MUGHAL
EMPIRE

AGRA

RAJPUT
STATES

TARKHAN

GWALIOR

MEWAR

MALWA

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA

AHMAD-
NAGAR

BERAR

GAJAPATI

BIJAPUR
SULTANATE

GOLKONDA

GOA (Por.)

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

MYSORE

GINGEE

NAYAKAS

TANJORE

MADURAI

VIJAYANAGARAS

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

2 CONQUEST OF GONDWANA



- 1 The kingdom of Gondwana (Garh-Katanga) included :
a) the Narmada valley and the northern portions of Madhya Pradesh
b) a number of Gond and Rajput principalities.
- 2 Gondwana was an independent state in Central India ruled by Rani Durgavati, the Chandella princess from Mahoba, and the widow of Dalpat Shah, son of Sangram Shah.
- 3 In 1564 AD, Asaf Khan, the Mughal governor of Allahabad, attacked Gondwana. The Rani fought gallantly but lost the battle.
- 4 She stabbed herself to death and Gondwana was annexed to the Mughal empire.
- 5 Akbar later restored the kingdom to Chandra Shah, the younger son of Sangram Shah.



KASHMIR

MUGHAL
EMPIRE

BIKANER

AJMER

RANTHAMBORE

JAISALMER

RAJPUT
STATES

KALINJAR

SURS

TARKHAN

MEWAR

MALWA

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

AHMEDABAD

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA

AHMAD-
NAGAR

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MYSORE

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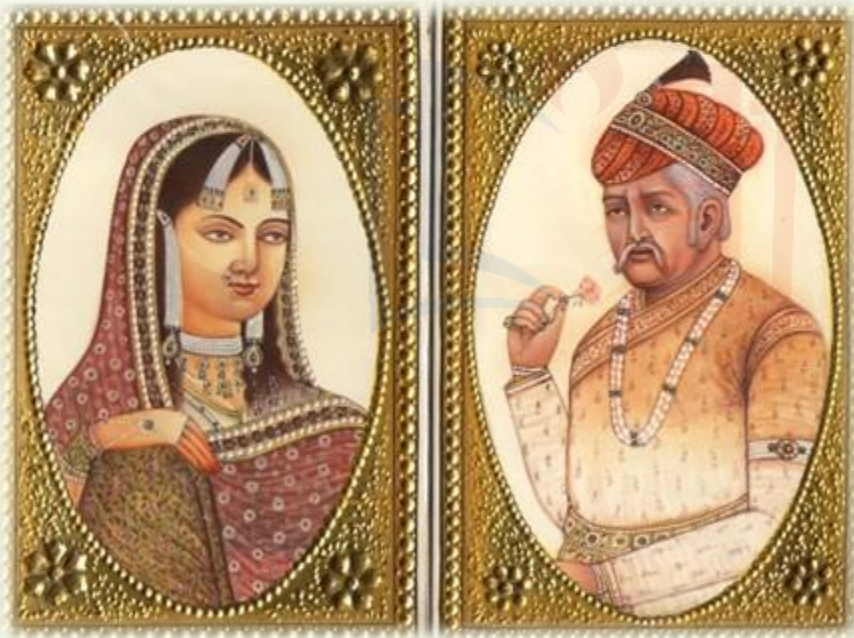
VIJAYANAGARAS

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

3 CONQUEST OF RAJPUT STATES



- 1 Akbar was fully aware of the importance of Rajput kingdoms and wanted them as allies in his ambition of establishing a large empire.
- 2 He tried to win over the Rajputs wherever possible and inducted them into Mughal service.
- 3 He also entered into matrimonial alliances with the Rajput rulers. For instance, Raja Bharmal of Amber married his eldest daughter Jodha Bai to Akbar.
- 4 Then, Raja Bhar Mal himself, his son Bhagwan Das, and grandson Man Singh joined the imperial Mughal service.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

3 CONQUEST OF RAJPUT STATES

5 Akbar's military conquests were extensive:

1) JODHPUR

- ✓ The Rajput kingdoms like Merta and Jodhpur were occupied without much resistance.

2) SIEGE OF CHITTOR (MEWAR):

- ✓ Chittor, held not only key to central Rajasthan but above all, it was a symbol of the Rajput spirit of resistance.
- ✓ In 1568 AD, Chittor fell after a gallant siege of six months. A large number of Rajput soldiers were killed in the war.
- ✓ However, it could not be fully subdued and some resistance from Mewar side continued for a long time.
- ✓ Later, Maharana Pratap, the ruler of Mewar, posed the most serious challenge to the Mughal emperor and did not submit before Akbar.
- ✓ In the famous Battle of Haldighati (1576 AD), Rana Pratap was defeated by the Mughal army led by Man Singh.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

3 CONQUEST OF RAJPUT STATES



6 3) OTHER RAJPUT STATES

- Following the defeat of Mewar, most of the leading Rajput rulers accepted Akbar's suzerainty.
- After the fall of Chittor, Ranthambhor (1569 AD) and Kalingar were captured.
- In 1570 AD, Marwar, Bikaner, and Jaisalmer also submitted to Akbar.

Thus by 1570 AD, Akbar had captured almost the whole of Rajasthan.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

NOTE



1 In spite of the subjugation of the whole of Rajasthan, Akbar ensured there was no hostility between the Rajputs and the Mughals.

2 Akbar's Rajput policy was combined with a broad religious tolerance.

- He abolished the pilgrim tax (1563 AD)
- He later abolished jiziya (1564 AD).
- He also prohibited forcible conversion of prisoners of war.

3 Many Rajput mansabdars were assigned their own territories as Watan Jagir, which was hereditary and non-transferable. They also rose to important positions in Mughal services.

4 The alliance on one hand secured the services of the bravest warriors to the Mughals whereas on the other hand, it ensured peace in Rajasthan

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

4

CONQUEST OF GUJARAT



- 1 In 1572 AD, Akbar advanced on Ahmedabad via Ajmer and defeated the Gujarat ruler Muzaffar Shah without any serious resistance.
- 2 It was in order to commemorate the victory of Gujarat that Akbar built the Buland Darwaza at Fatehpur Sikri.
- 3 Surat, with a strong fortress, offered some resistance but was also captured.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

4 CONQUEST OF GUJARAT



4 In a short time, most of the principalities of Gujarat were brought under his control. Akbar organised Gujarat into a province and placed it under his Governor and returned to capital. However, just within six months various rebellious groups rose.

5 Hearing the news, Akbar marched out of Agra at a rapid pace along with his soldiers. He quickly suppressed the rebellion in 1573 AD.

After this, Akbar turned his attention to Bengal.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

5 CONQUEST OF BIHAR AND BENGAL

- 1 The Afghans had continued to dominate Bihar and Bengal.
- 2 There were Internal fights among the Afghans, and the declaration of independence by the new ruler Daud Khan, gave Akbar the opportunity he was seeking.
- 3 In 1574 AD, Akbar along with Khan-i-Khanan Munaim Khan, marched towards Bihar. In a short time, he captured Hajipur, Patna, and Gaur (Bengal).
- 4 Daud was forced to accept for peace settlement but he soon rose in rebellion again.
- 5 In a stiff battle in Bihar in 1576 AD, Daud Khan was defeated and executed on the spot.

With this, the independent rule of Bengal was ended.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

AKBAR (1556 AD- 1605 AD)

MUGHALS EXPANSION UNDER AKBAR

6 CONQUEST OF DECCAN



- 1** In 1595 AD, the Mughal forces invaded Ahmednagar and Chand Bibi (the deceased Sultan's sister) was defeated.
- 2**
 - After heavy losses on both sides, a treaty was worked out and Chand Bibi ceded Berar to Mughals.
 - After some time, Chand Bibi attacked Berar to take it back with support from Adilshahi and Qutabshahi.
 - The Mughals suffered heavy losses but could retain their position.

MUGHAL DYNASTY

1556 AD



1605 AD



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